

SnowyKim Historical HR Case Resolution Log

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Purpose

This log summarizes selected fictional workplace cases previously handled by SnowyKim. It is intended to help authorized HR personnel identify prior practices, recurring risks, and potential process improvements.

Prior outcomes do not automatically determine the outcome of a new case. Each matter must be evaluated based on its own facts, applicable law, current policy, available evidence, and consistency considerations.

Case 1: Repeated Inappropriate Jokes

Case ID: HR-2021-001

Year: 2021

Location: San Francisco

Category: Harassment

Parties: Individual contributor and multiple coworkers

Issue: Several employees reported repeated jokes concerning gender and appearance during team meetings.

Investigation: HR interviewed the reporting employees, the accused employee, the manager, and two witnesses. Messages supporting portions of the complaints were reviewed.

Finding: Substantiated.

Resolution: The employee received a final written warning and mandatory harassment-prevention training. The manager was instructed to reinforce meeting-conduct expectations.

Follow-Up: No additional complaints were received during the following 12 months.

Case 2: Unapproved Salary Disclosure

Case ID: HR-2021-002

Year: 2021

Location: New York City

Category: Confidentiality

Parties: Payroll employee and two coworkers

Issue: A payroll employee accessed and shared coworkers' salary information without an authorized business purpose.

Investigation: System-access logs and relevant messages were reviewed.

Finding: Substantiated.

Resolution: The employee's payroll access was immediately suspended. Employment was terminated following review by HR and Legal.

Follow-Up: Payroll access reviews were changed from annual to quarterly.

Important Note: The issue was unauthorized disclosure of information obtained through privileged system access—not employees discussing their own wages.

Case 3: Alleged Promotion Discrimination

Case ID: HR-2021-003

Year: 2021

Location: San Francisco

Category: Discrimination

Parties: Employee and department manager

Issue: An employee alleged that they were denied promotion because of age.

Investigation: HR reviewed performance records, promotion criteria, comparator information, and manager communications.

Finding: Inconclusive. The available evidence did not establish age-based decision-making, but promotion criteria were poorly documented.

Resolution: The promotion decision remained in place. The department implemented written promotion criteria and required documented selection rationales.

Follow-Up: HR reviewed the department's next two promotion cycles.

Case 4: Retaliation After Complaint

Case ID: HR-2021-004

Year: 2021

Location: New York City

Category: Retaliation

Parties: Employee and direct manager

Issue: After an employee reported inappropriate conduct, the manager removed the employee from meetings and reassigned visible projects.

Investigation: HR compared assignments and meeting invitations before and after the complaint and interviewed relevant team members.

Finding: Substantiated.

Resolution: The manager received a final written warning, management training, and reduced personnel authority for six months. The employee's prior responsibilities were restored.

Follow-Up: HR conducted monthly retaliation check-ins for six months.

Case 5: Expense Reimbursement Fraud

Case ID: HR-2022-001

Year: 2022

Location: San Francisco

Category: Dishonesty

Parties: Sales employee

Issue: The employee submitted altered receipts and duplicate reimbursement requests.

Investigation: Finance and HR reviewed receipts, payment records, and merchant information.

Finding: Substantiated.

Resolution: Employment was terminated. The employee was required to repay improperly reimbursed amounts.

Follow-Up: Finance introduced automated duplicate-expense detection.

Case 6: Workplace Bullying Complaint

Case ID: HR-2022-002

Year: 2022

Location: New York City

Category: Abusive Conduct

Parties: Manager and three direct reports

Issue: Employees reported public humiliation, shouting, and deliberately withholding information needed to complete assignments.

Investigation: HR interviewed seven employees and reviewed relevant communications.

Finding: Substantiated in part. Public humiliation and information withholding were supported; other allegations could not be confirmed.

Resolution: The manager received a written warning, leadership coaching, and a 90-day improvement plan.

Follow-Up: A team survey showed improvement after six months.

Case 7: Religious Accommodation Request

Case ID: HR-2022-003

Year: 2022

Location: San Francisco

Category: Accommodation

Parties: Operations employee and manager

Issue: An employee requested recurring schedule modifications for religious observance.

Review: HR discussed the request, essential scheduling needs, and possible alternatives with the employee and manager.

Finding: Accommodation was feasible.

Resolution: The employee received a modified schedule and arranged coverage for specified periods.

Follow-Up: The arrangement was reviewed after 90 days and continued.

Case 8: Improper Medical Information Sharing

Case ID: HR-2022-004

Year: 2022

Location: New York City

Category: Privacy and Confidentiality

Parties: Manager and direct report

Issue: A manager disclosed an employee's medical diagnosis to coworkers while explaining the employee's absence.

Investigation: The manager acknowledged making the disclosure.

Finding: Substantiated.

Resolution: The manager received a written warning and confidentiality training. The affected employee received a written apology and HR support.

Follow-Up: Manager leave notifications were revised to exclude medical details.

Case 9: Romantic Relationship Conflict

Case ID: HR-2023-001

Year: 2023

Location: San Francisco

Category: Conflict of Interest

Parties: Manager and indirect report

Issue: A manager failed to disclose a romantic relationship with an employee whose compensation the manager influenced.

Investigation: HR confirmed the relationship and reviewed compensation decisions.

Finding: Substantiated.

Resolution: The reporting structure was changed, the manager was removed from compensation decisions, and both employees received conflict-of-interest guidance. The manager received a written warning for nondisclosure.

Follow-Up: No evidence of improper compensation was identified.

Case 10: Disability Accommodation Delay

Case ID: HR-2023-002

Year: 2023

Location: New York City

Category: Accommodation

Parties: Employee, manager, and HR coordinator

Issue: An employee's request for assistive software remained unresolved for six weeks.

Investigation: HR reviewed correspondence and identified unclear ownership between IT and HR.

Finding: Process failure substantiated; intentional discrimination was not established.

Resolution: The software was provided, related expenses were reimbursed, and a single accommodation-case owner was assigned.

Follow-Up: SnowyKim introduced response deadlines and escalation reminders.

Case 11: Falsified Time Records

Case ID: HR-2023-003

Year: 2023

Location: San Francisco

Category: Timekeeping

Parties: Nonexempt employee

Issue: Records indicated repeated entries for hours that were not worked.

Investigation: HR reviewed access records, schedules, time entries, and the employee's explanation.

Finding: Substantiated.

Resolution: The employee received a final written warning and was required to use supervised timekeeping for 90 days. Termination was not selected because the amount was limited and there was no prior misconduct.

Follow-Up: No further discrepancies were identified.

Case 12: Off-the-Clock Work Directed by Manager

Case ID: HR-2023-004

Year: 2023

Location: New York City

Category: Wage and Hour

Parties: Manager and four nonexempt employees

Issue: Employees were instructed to answer messages after clocking out.

Investigation: HR reviewed messages, time records, and manager instructions.

Finding: Substantiated.

Resolution: Employees received corrected wages. The manager received a final written warning and wage-and-hour training.

Follow-Up: The department's records were audited for six additional months.

Case 13: Misuse of Generative AI

Case ID: HR-2024-001

Year: 2024

Location: San Francisco

Category: Technology and Confidentiality

Parties: Marketing employee

Issue: The employee uploaded confidential customer strategy materials into an unapproved public AI application.

Investigation: Information Security assessed the uploaded data, account configuration, and potential exposure.

Finding: Substantiated.

Resolution: The employee received a written warning and security retraining. Access to unapproved browser applications was restricted.

Follow-Up: The company issued an approved-AI application policy.

Case 14: Hiring Interview Misconduct

Case ID: HR-2024-002

Year: 2024

Location: New York City

Category: Recruiting Conduct

Parties: Interviewer and candidate

Issue: An interviewer asked a candidate about marriage, children, and childcare plans.

Investigation: The recruiter's notes and the interviewer's account confirmed the questions.

Finding: Substantiated.

Resolution: The interviewer was removed from the hiring panel and required to complete interviewer training. The candidate received a new interview with a different panel.

Follow-Up: Interviewers were required to complete training before receiving candidate-system access.

Case 15: Suspected Favoritism in Performance Ratings

Case ID: HR-2024-003

Year: 2024

Location: San Francisco

Category: Performance Management

Parties: Manager and department employees

Issue: Employees alleged that a manager consistently gave higher ratings to close personal friends.

Investigation: HR reviewed ratings, written evidence, objectives, and comparator information across three cycles.

Finding: Inconclusive regarding intentional favoritism, but ratings were insufficiently supported.

Resolution: Ratings were recalibrated, and the manager was required to document evidence for future evaluations.

Follow-Up: HR participated in the next performance-calibration cycle.

Case 16: Threatening Workplace Message

Case ID: HR-2024-004

Year: 2024

Location: New York City

Category: Workplace Safety

Parties: Employee and coworker

Issue: An employee sent a message that a coworker reasonably interpreted as threatening physical harm.

Investigation: HR and Security reviewed the message, prior communications, and immediate safety concerns.

Finding: Substantiated.

Resolution: The employee was placed on administrative leave during review and later terminated.

Follow-Up: Security support and schedule adjustments were provided to the affected coworker.

Case 17: PTO Retaliation Concern

Case ID: HR-2025-001

Year: 2025

Location: San Francisco

Category: Leave and Retaliation

Parties: Employee and manager

Issue: An employee alleged receiving a lower rating because they had used approved leave.

Investigation: HR reviewed ratings, manager notes, attendance references, and comparator information.

Finding: Substantiated in part. The manager improperly considered protected leave when discussing reliability.

Resolution: The rating was revised, and the manager received a written warning and leave-law training.

Follow-Up: HR reviewed all ratings submitted by the manager that cycle.

Case 18: Unauthorized Employee-Record Access

Case ID: HR-2025-002

Year: 2025

Location: New York City

Category: Data Privacy

Parties: HR staff member

Issue: Audit logs showed that an HR employee repeatedly viewed records of individuals unrelated to assigned work.

Investigation: HR reviewed system logs, case assignments, and the employee's explanation.

Finding: Substantiated.

Resolution: The employee's HR-system access was suspended and employment was terminated following Legal review.

Follow-Up: Role-based restrictions and automated access alerts were strengthened.

Case 19: Performance Complaint Not Substantiated

Case ID: HR-2025-003

Year: 2025

Location: San Francisco

Category: Manager Conduct

Parties: Employee and manager

Issue: An employee alleged that critical feedback was retaliatory after a disagreement with the manager.

Investigation: HR reviewed the timeline, prior feedback, objectives, communications, and comparator treatment.

Finding: Unsubstantiated. Performance concerns were documented before the disagreement and were applied consistently.

Resolution: No corrective action was taken against the manager. HR facilitated a meeting to clarify expectations and communication standards.

Follow-Up: The manager conducted biweekly documented check-ins for three months.

Case 20: Payroll Bank-Change Phishing Incident

Case ID: HR-2026-001

Year: 2026

Location: New York City

Category: Security and Payroll

Parties: Payroll employee and affected employee

Issue: A fraudulent email impersonating an employee requested a direct-deposit change.

Investigation: Information Security reviewed email headers, payroll activity, and authentication records.

Finding: External fraud attempt. No employee misconduct was found, but verification procedures were not followed.

Resolution: The payment was stopped before completion. The payroll employee received coaching, and all bank-account changes were changed to require multifactor identity verification.

Follow-Up: Payroll staff completed phishing-response training.

Case Summary

Category	Number of cases
Harassment, discrimination, or retaliation	5
Confidentiality, privacy, or security	5
Accommodation or leave	3
Wage, payroll, or timekeeping	3
Conduct or conflicts of interest	3
Recruiting	1
Total	20

Outcome Summary

Outcome	Number of cases
Substantiated	14
Substantiated in part	3
Inconclusive	2
Unsubstantiated	1

Use of Historical Cases

Authorized personnel may use this log to:

- Identify potentially similar prior cases
- Review how corrective measures were previously selected
- Identify recurring control failures
- Locate related policies and procedures
- Support consistency reviews
- Develop training and prevention measures

This log must not be used to:

- Automatically determine a new case's outcome
- Replace an investigation
- Produce disciplinary decisions without human review
- Search for cases out of curiosity
- Disclose case details to unauthorized employees
- Infer that identical allegations always require identical discipline

Factors that may justify different outcomes include:

- Strength of evidence
- Severity of conduct
- Intent
- Impact
- Prior relevant conduct
- Position and authority
- Cooperation
- Applicable law and policy at the time
- Corrective actions available
- Risk of recurrence

Demonstration disclaimer: All cases, parties, outcomes, and events in this log are fictional. This document is intended for HR chatbot, retrieval, access-control, and evaluation testing. It is not legal advice.